3.2 Pillar 2: Transform supply

Supply sets the ceiling on the growth case. The airport caps arrivals before its relief arrives, and outside the Metro the product exists but is hard to reach, book or stay in.

The December tree asked the pillar to remove mobility, infrastructure and product constraints so as to expand the province's physical carrying capacity (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64). The evidence confirmed the objective and located each constraint.

- **The gateway.** Current air access caps inbound seats at 1.8 million, and the base case passes that ceiling at the 2030 year point (Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p21). New terminal space at Cape Town International is due about 2032 and the runway about 2033 (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p103).
- **The regions.** Accessibility scores fall from 4.7 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo, and one touring route of six is rated Ready (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p88 to p90, p29).
- **The product.** The constraint is less about creating new attractions and more about turning existing assets into complete, accessible visitor experiences (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114).

Two structural changes happened in this pillar. The December entry on air access and cruise split in two, because MIDAS gave air access its own evidence base. The Infrastructure Report found cruise to be a product and marketing lever, with Cape Town's berth at about 40% of its season capacity (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p110). The entry on infrastructure, visa and safety deficits moved to Pillar 3 because its levers sit nationally (section 3.3.2).

The Infrastructure Report reads transport as a connectivity and dispersal challenge, not a province-wide capacity crisis, with Cape Town International the key gateway risk (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114). Pillar 2 follows that reading: one capacity entry at the gateway and five entries about reach, product and experience.

Table 3.8. Pillar 2 holds six focus areas: the air entry was reworded, cruise is new and the four others carried through as Validated.

Focus area	Disposition	What the evidence showed	Initiative
7 Win direct routes and add seats on full routes	Reworded	Eleven of 27 routes run above 80% load, fares rise before seats, and runway relief lands about 2033	I6
8 Grow cruise calls and ports	New	Cape Town's berth runs at about 40% of season capacity; growth comes through product and marketing	I7
9 Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility	Validated	Accessibility falls from 4.7 in the Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo	I8
10 Support diversified route and product development	Validated	Assets outside the Metro are not turned into product, and one route of six is Ready	I9
11 Align visitor experience in-destination	Validated	No mid-scale branded tier sits between luxury estates and basic self-catering	I10
12 Balance impact on nature-based attractions	Validated	Boulders is near carrying capacity and Cableway queues reach three hours	I11

Source: Chapter 3 entries 7 to 12. Dispositions as recorded at the 14 October 2026 review [Summary of Findings, 14 Oct 2026, pp15 to 16: deck page reference to be confirmed].

3.2.1 Accessibility, connectivity and infrastructure

The first supply theme covers how visitors reach the province and move through it. It holds three focus areas: air access, cruise and internal mobility. The December entry on visa and safety deficits left this theme for section 3.3.2.

THEME 2.1 · ACCESSIBILITY, CONNECTIVITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE · FOCUS AREA 7

Win direct routes and add seats on full routes

Eleven of 27 international routes run above 80% load and carriers raise fares before seats, so the province must win frequency and larger aircraft now, ahead of runway relief in about 2033.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Close the Air Access and Cruise Capacity Gaps (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64). The air half of the entry became this focus area and the cruise half became focus area 8.

October 2026: Reworded. The October record gives the reason as 16 of 27 routes above 80% and fares before seats. MIDAS, the source, prints eleven routes above 80%; sixteen is the count at 75% or more, and the report uses both on that basis [Summary of Findings, 14 Oct 2026: the deck's basis for 16 to confirm]. MIDAS and the Infrastructure Report's air-access section drove the change.

Evidence

Table 3.9. The network is full on its best routes, the airport is full at its runway, and relief lands after the base case passes the seat ceiling.

Finding	Figure	Source
Routes are full	11 of 27 tabled routes above 80% load and 16 at 75% or more; network load 76.0%	MIDAS, Seasonality
Fares before seats	Carriers on full routes will seek higher fares rather than add services, though there is tactical room for added frequency and larger aircraft	MIDAS, In Conclusion
A record to build on	17 mainline international routes added from 2015 to 2025, ahead of Santiago (14), Valencia (12) and Calgary (8)	MIDAS, International Comparisons
A seat ceiling in 2030	Current air access caps inbound seats at 1.8 million; the base case passes it at the 2030 year point (1,802,929)	DSA p21
Relief lands late	The single runway caps movements at about 30 an hour; ACSA's ~R11.3bn programme brings the international terminal about 2032 and the runway about 2033	IR p102, p103
Second gateways	George is solved by 2028 (R310m, to about 2m passengers); Cape Winelands is an upside bet with no firm named carrier	IR p104 to p109

Source: MIDAS Aviation Market Assessment, Mar 2026 (twelve months to November 2025; 76.0% is the printed network total and the 27 rows sum to 75.0%); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR).

The Infrastructure Report puts the timing problem in one line: the certain fix is the latest, and the earliest big-capacity option is the least certain (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p109). No airline took part in the first phase of stakeholder engagement, so the carriers' own view of frequency and gauge is still to be tested (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p16).

Recommendation

Wesgro should split the air agenda by horizon. Until about 2032 the job is to fill and enlarge what already flies: frequency and larger aircraft on the full routes, hub-carrier capacity and the five regional routes MIDAS names. After that, the job is to have direct India and China route cases ready when runway capacity arrives. The Demand-Side Analysis lists the moves: added frequency from Emirates, Qatar Airways and Ethiopian Airlines, long-term route cases for India and China, and coordinated airline incentives through Cape Town Air Access (Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p54).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Run a seat-retention and frequency programme on the full routes, with joint marketing tied to route performance	Air Access; Destination Marketing; airlines
Wesgro	Set up a public-private air access fund for route support, on the Chilean model	Air Access; DEDAT; City of Cape Town; private sector
Wesgro	Treat runway delivery as the first risk: track approvals and milestones quarterly and commission a capacity-against-demand model to 2035	Air Access; Research
Partners	Deliver the runway, terminals and George upgrade on the published dates; close the funding and name a carrier at Cape Winelands	ACSA; Cape Winelands Airport
National	Escalate bilateral air service agreements, the cap on US carriers and immigration processing at Cape Town International	Department of Transport; Home Affairs

Benchmark precedent

Chile treated its gateway airport as economic infrastructure: a private concession funded a ~US$900 million expansion at Santiago, and international seats grew ~40% to 50% between 2013 and 2019 under open-skies agreements (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p23, p25, p26). The required change for the Western Cape is a permanent, well-funded public-private air access fund and active lobbying for air service liberalisation (p28).

Link forward

Initiative I6, route development and seat retention with a public-private air access fund (section 4.3).
Indicators T1-01 international arrivals at impact level, and T2-09 seats and routes and T2-10 routes above 80% load at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 2.1 · ACCESSIBILITY, CONNECTIVITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE · FOCUS AREA 8

Grow cruise calls and ports

Cruise already brings about R1.79bn a year with Cape Town's berth at about 40% of its season capacity, so growth comes from ships, excursions and regional day stops, not from port capital.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Close the Air Access and Cruise Capacity Gaps (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64), the cruise half of the entry.

October 2026: New. The October record gives 79 calls in 2024/25 and a plan to 250. The Infrastructure Report's cruise and ports section drove the split from air access: cruise runs well below berth capacity and is a product and marketing lever, a different problem from the airport.

Evidence

Table 3.10. Cape Town's berth has room, ship size and wind are the constraints, and port capital is going to freight.

Finding	Figure	Source
Calls and passengers	79 vessels and 127,178 passengers in 2024/25, up from 67 vessels in 2023/24	Diag p37
A berth with room	Cape Town's equipped berth ran at about 40% of a season capacity of 150 or more calls; 83 calls and R1.79bn economic impact in 2024/25	IR p110
Ship size and wind bind	300m maximum ship length at the equipped berth; the South-Easter delays berthing; no shore power	IR p110
Regional ports extend the route	Mossel Bay 21 calls and about 13,000 passengers, with a R22m reception facility opened in November 2025; Saldanha Bay 3 trial calls into an ore terminal	IR p111
Port capital is for freight	Cape Town's container expansion and Saldanha's R4bn iron-ore expansion add no cruise capacity; the R22m Mossel Bay facility is the only cruise capital	IR p112
Packaging works	Mossel Bay calls rose from four before COVID to 27 a season through closer coordination and better excursion packaging, with Wesgro credited	SIR p20, p21

Source: Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Western Cape Cruise Liner Industry Economic Contribution 2024/25 Season, cited through the Diagnostic); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR). The Diagnostic counts 79 vessels and the Infrastructure Report 83 calls for the same season; passengers and economic impact agree. Mossel Bay's 27 a season is its own figure; the Infrastructure Report prints 21.

The plan to 250 calls in the October record appears in no deliverable. Cape Town's season capacity is about 150 calls, so 250 would need a second berth, a longer season or the regional ports counted in, and no document describes any of these [plan to 250 cruise calls: source, horizon and definition to confirm with Cruise Cape Town]. The report carries the 2024/25 baseline and holds the target open until the source is in hand.

Recommendation

Wesgro should grow cruise through ships, excursions and regional day stops. The Infrastructure Report's own conclusion is to grow it through product and marketing, not capital works (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p112). Cape Town anchors the itinerary, and Mossel Bay and Saldanha Bay extend it west and east as day stops rather than home ports (p111). The Inception Report names home porting and expedition vessels as the segments that bring longer stays and higher local spend (Inception Report, Nov 2025, p9).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Market Cape Town to lines whose ships fit the 300m berth and to expedition and home-porting operators, with pre- and post-cruise stays	Cruise Cape Town; Destination Marketing
Wesgro	Back Mossel Bay now with packaged excursions and line marketing; keep Saldanha Bay on watch until demand is proven	Cruise Cape Town; Mossel Bay municipality
Wesgro	Put community and regional product on cruise-operator channels, starting with a bookable walk in the Knysna townships	Cruise Cape Town; LTOs
Partners	Manage berth scheduling and wind delays at Cape Town, plan for shore power and review the 300m limit	Transnet National Ports Authority; V&A Waterfront
National	Put cruise into port planning, since current Western Cape port capital carries no cruise capacity	Transnet

Benchmark precedent

The Benchmarking Report has no cruise case, and its final screening replaced the cruise criterion used at inception with ease of access and visas (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p11; Inception Report, Nov 2025, p30). The nearest analogue is Singapore's stopover programme, in which the tourism board, the airport and the airline share one strategy to turn transit passengers into visitors (p40).

Link forward

Initiative I7, cruise growth through product (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-11 cruise calls and passengers at outcome level, with the target held open until the 250-call plan is sourced (section 5.2).

THEME 2.1 · ACCESSIBILITY, CONNECTIVITY AND INFRASTRUCTURE · FOCUS AREA 9

Accelerate tourism-enabling internal mobility

Accessibility falls from 4.7 out of 5 in the Cape Metro to 1.0 in the Central Karoo, and beyond the Metro and the Garden Route the province is effectively car-only.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Accelerate Tourism-Enabling Internal Mobility (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64).

October 2026: Validated. Access decays from 4.7 to 1.0. The Infrastructure Report's comparative regional analysis and the Department of Mobility's evidence to the stakeholder programme drove the disposition. The 4.7 is the Metro's score on attractions and services; on transport it scores 5.0.

Evidence

Table 3.11. Access falls away with distance from Cape Town, and the rail and road assets that exist are not run for visitors.

Finding	Figure	Source
Access decays with distance	Accessibility Cape Metro 4.7 (5.0 on transport), Cape Winelands 3.3, Garden Route 3.0, Overberg 2.0, West Coast 1.7, Central Karoo 1.0	IR p88 to p90
One corridor, mostly car-only	The N2 is the only continuous inter-regional tourism corridor; beyond the Metro and the Garden Route the province is effectively car-only	IR p98, p99
Rail exists but not for visitors	Metrorail runs 104 of 121 stations and 22.7m trips (FY2025), but no rail reaches the airport and the Southern Line's visitor branding dates to 2007	IR p100
The Metro's last mile is unfunded	MyCiTi Phase 2 (R3.3bn) does not reach Chapman's Peak, Constantia or Cape Point south	IR p32
No shuttles between towns	No inter-town shuttle on the Garden Route despite obvious demand; no public tourism transport between Hermanus, Stanford, Elim and Agulhas	IR p90, p67
Stakeholders rank it high	18 insight rows from 8 of 16 organisations, 10 rated High, including public transport and airport transfer times	SIR p22, p20 to p46

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; comparative regional analysis on a 1 to 5 scale); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; the theme count is reconstructed from the appendix tables, which print no tally).

The Infrastructure Report's conclusion frames the entry: transport is primarily a connectivity and dispersal challenge, not a province-wide capacity crisis (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114). The Department of Mobility adds that mobility responsibilities are split across three tiers of government (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p23).

Recommendation

Wesgro should not try to build transport. It should make the transport that exists usable for visitors and aggregate the demand that makes shuttles viable. The Southern Line is a ready-made, low-cost scenic corridor through Muizenberg, Kalk Bay, Boulders and Simon's Town (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p100). On the West Coast, operators say a shared shuttle needs demand aggregation and booking integration to work (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p41).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Package the Southern Line as a visitor product, with refreshed branding and day passes	Tourism; Destination Marketing; City of Cape Town; PRASA
Wesgro	Aggregate demand and bookings for corridor shuttles, starting on the Garden Route and between Cape Town, Darling and the West Coast	Tourism; district municipalities; private operators
Wesgro	Sell the transfer inside the itinerary on the N2 and R62 routes, so visitors without a car can buy the trip	Destination Marketing; operators
Partners	Complete the Central Line recovery, MyCiTi Phase 2 and the unfunded last mile to Cape Point, with integrated ticketing	City of Cape Town; PRASA; Department of Mobility
Partners	Take forward the Cape Town to George rapid rail assessment and extend the George public transport model	Department of Mobility
National	Lift the national rule that blocks bank-card payments on the George bus, and fund passenger rail beyond the Metro	National government; PRASA

Benchmark precedent

No benchmark case carries an internal mobility lever with figures. The nearest is Chile, where a domestic air network links Santiago to Patagonia, Atacama, Valparaíso and the wine valleys, run as a designed portfolio rather than standalone attractions (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p25, p27).

Link forward

Initiative I8, corridor mobility (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-06 share of arrivals and spend outside the Metro at impact level, and T2-12 accessibility score by district and T2-13 corridor transfer products at outcome level (section 5.2).

3.2.2 Product and destination capacity

The second supply theme covers what visitors find once they arrive: product beyond the icons, the quality of the stay and the limits of the flagship sites. All three December entries carried through as Validated.

THEME 2.2 · PRODUCT AND DESTINATION CAPACITY · FOCUS AREA 10

Support diversified route and product development

The province does not lack attractions; it lacks finished experiences around them, with assets outside the Metro left without guides, interpretation or bookable product and one touring route of six rated Ready.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Support Diversified Route and Product Development (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64).

October 2026: Validated. Idle assets and cold zones. The Infrastructure Report's spatial maps and route scorecards drove the disposition, and 11 of the 16 organisations in the stakeholder programme raised the theme. Cold zones is the report's own term; idle assets paraphrases its finding that assets are inactivated or underused.

Evidence

Table 3.12. Assets are spread across the province, but product, packaging and investment stop at the core routes.

Finding	Figure	Source
Assets are spread	50,332 mapped tourism assets; the Cape Metro holds 40.3% and the five other districts the rest	IR p2, p23
Assets are not activated	Overberg and West Coast marine and wildflower assets have no guided tours, interpretation centres or bookable product; the Central Karoo and northern inland are attraction deserts	IR p93
Cold zones in every district	Industrial belts with zero tourism conversion in the Metro; the inland Garden Route north of the N2; the Rûens interior; the N1 transit corridor in the Central Karoo	IR p24, p35, p68, p79
One route is Ready	Cape Peninsula Ready; Garden Route, Cape Winelands, Whale Coast and Route 62 Developing; West Coast and Cederberg Emerging	IR p29, p39, p50, p61, p72, p83
No capital for product	Non-wine diversification in the Winelands is strategy, not committed capital; De Hoop lacks accommodation investment; Overberg year-round product is unfunded	IR p54, p76
Stakeholders see concentration	11 of 16 organisations raised the theme; the offer is seen as concentrated around Cape Town and a narrow set of icons	SIR p11

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR; route ratings are approximate and the asset count carries no year); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; organisation count reconstructed from the appendix tables).

The Infrastructure Report's own conclusion is that the constraint is less about creating new attractions and more about turning existing assets into complete, accessible visitor experiences (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114). No deliverable counts the assets that have no product around them [assets with no bookable product or guided access, by district: needs the Wesgro supply database behind the 50,332 count].

Recommendation

Wesgro should deepen the three corridors closest to ready, the Garden Route, the Cape Winelands and the Overberg, and package the two outer routes as slow-travel products. The Infrastructure Report places the strongest regional opportunity in deepening existing corridors through connectivity, packaging and service depth (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p114). Dispersal needs deliberate corridor investment, not organic spillover from Cape Town (p5). Stellenbosch and George can anchor regional business events (Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p41).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Package bookable multi-day itineraries on each of the six touring routes, starting with the Whale Coast east of Hermanus, Route 62 and the West Coast	Tourism; Destination Marketing; LTOs
Wesgro	Activate cold-zone assets with guided tours, interpretation and bookable product, beginning with the marine and wildflower assets	Tourism; CapeNature; SANParks; LTOs
Wesgro	Build regional conference offers in Stellenbosch and George, with stays before and after Cape Town events	Convention Bureau
Partners	Invest in accommodation and service depth beyond Hermanus, in Route 62's secondary towns and beyond Langebaan and Paternoster (focus area 15)	Accommodation investors; municipalities
Partners	Refresh flagship product: Robben Island beyond the prison tour; the Cableway's lower station	Robben Island Museum; Table Mountain Aerial Cableway
National	Complete SA Connect rural broadband and SANParks precinct projects such as the R81.7m Agulhas lighthouse precinct	National government; SANParks

Benchmark precedent

Chile ran Santiago, Valparaíso, the wine valleys and Patagonia as one portfolio, which raised global awareness, earned revenue in the shoulder season and lengthened stays as visitors explored several regions (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p27). The required change for the Western Cape is to sell experiences as curated journeys and move from asset marketing to experience-led packaging (p28).

Link forward

Initiative I9, corridor product development (section 4.3). **Indicators** T1-06 share of arrivals and spend outside the Metro at impact level and T2-14 readiness by district at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 2.2 · PRODUCT AND DESTINATION CAPACITY · FOCUS AREA 11

Align visitor experience in-destination

The province offers luxury estates and basic self-catering with no mid-scale branded tier between them, and service, interpretation and language readiness thin out with distance from Cape Town.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Align Visitor Experience In-Destination (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64).

October 2026: Validated. Mid-scale gap. The Infrastructure Report's accommodation mapping, the stakeholder evidence on service quality and the Valencia and Singapore benchmarks drove the disposition. The gap is stated in words; no deliverable counts mid-scale rooms.

Evidence

Table 3.13. The experience breaks at the middle of the accommodation market, at the service counter and at the arrival gate.

Finding	Figure	Source
No mid-scale tier	Province-wide, no midscale branded product sits between luxury estates and basic self-catering; mid-market stock is effectively absent outside Stellenbosch	IR p95, p47
Accommodation range thins	Accommodation range Ready on three routes, Developing on the Whale Coast and Route 62, and Gap on the West Coast	IR p30, p40, p51, p62, p73, p84
A two-tier system	Strong product sits where visitors cannot easily reach or afford it; accommodation readiness 4.7 in the Metro against 2.0 in the Central Karoo	IR p89
Service is uneven	Mossel Bay calls restaurant quality and service a major weakness; CapeNature is wary of scaling international demand because service readiness is uneven	SIR p20, p43
Growth markets need adapting	Limited Mandarin-language services; little visibility of vegetarian options or Indian-language guides; no Arabic-language booking or local-currency options	DSA p51
The arrival is the weak point	The international airport is the most negative node in Cape Town's online mentions; immigration processing and peak-hour throughput need work	Diag p22; DSA p54

Source: Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR); Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR); Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026 (DSA); Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025 (Diag; Mentionlytics sentiment data).

Two measures are missing. No deliverable counts mid-scale rooms or beds [mid-scale room count by district: needs the Wesgro supply database or an accommodation audit], and none prints a visitor satisfaction score. The only accommodation figure in hand is a demand share: 3.6% of 2024 visitors stayed in hotels, against 17.4% in self-catering (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p27).

Recommendation

Wesgro should lead a province-wide quality and standards framework and make the investment case for mid-scale accommodation in secondary nodes. The Benchmarking Report assigns the framework to Wesgro in so many words: a province-wide quality and standards framework that aligns all tourism stakeholders under consistent benchmarks led by Wesgro (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p42). Valencia shows the form: a provincial quality charter, phased by district, with certification visible on booking platforms (p49).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Set up a provincial quality charter, phased by district, with certification visible on booking platforms and support for SMMEs to comply	Tourism; DEDAT; industry bodies
Wesgro	Prepare for growth markets: multilingual guiding, digital payments and culturally relevant product for Chinese, Indian and Gulf visitors	Tourism; Destination Marketing
Wesgro	Make the investment case for mid-scale and conference-capable hotels in George and Mossel Bay, east of Hermanus and on Route 62 (focus area 15)	Tourism; private investors
Partners	Close service and interpretation gaps at named sites: Robben Island interpretation, CapeNature service readiness, restaurant quality in Mossel Bay	Attraction operators; municipalities; CATHSSETA
National	Improve immigration processing and peak-hour throughput at Cape Town International, and deliver the terminal relief due about 2032	Home Affairs; ACSA

Benchmark precedent

Singapore's tourism board used a hotel industry transformation map, a hotel rejuvenation fund and the Hotels Act to move the destination from short stopovers toward longer stays and higher spend (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p41). Valencia's Qualitur programme and SICTED quality system raised service consistency, reputation and repeat visitation (p47).

Link forward

Initiative I10, visitor experience and quality standards (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-15 routes rated Ready at outcome level (section 5.2).

THEME 2.2 · PRODUCT AND DESTINATION CAPACITY · FOCUS AREA 12

Balance impact on nature-based attractions

Boulders is near carrying capacity and Cableway queues reach three hours, so growth at the flagship nature sites must come from managing flows and steering visitors to under-marketed reserves.

Hypothesis and disposition

December 2025. Balance Impact on Nature-Based Attractions (Current State Diagnostic, Dec 2025, p64).

October 2026: Validated. Flagship limits. The stakeholder evidence on Boulders and Table Mountain and the Infrastructure Report's record of flagship congestion drove the disposition. The operators and the province state the limits; no deliverable prints a visitor cap or carrying-capacity figure for any flagship site.

Evidence

Table 3.14. The flagship sites are at or near their limits, the overflow reserves are under-marketed and climate is already closing sites.

Finding	Figure	Source
Boulders is near capacity	Some nature-based attractions, Boulders among them, are already near carrying capacity, so more volume there is undesirable (Department of Economic Development)	SIR p24
The summit cannot grow	Environmental restrictions limit permanent expansion on Table Mountain's summit; peak queues run up to three hours up and two hours down	SIR p36; IR p28
Overflow is under-marketed	Peak-season congestion at flagship sites while overflow reserves remain under-marketed	IR p88
Tourism funds conservation	CapeNature's ecotourism income pays for alien clearing, fire response and species protection, and public funding alone will not suffice	SIR p43, p44
Climate already bites	Flooding, fire and heat are closing CapeNature sites; weather cancellations cost Robben Island roughly R16m a year	SIR p43, p33
Seasonal windows are narrow	Whale season peaks from September to November; climate change threatens the predictability of the wildflower season	IR p67, p64

Source: Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026 (SIR; insight statements by organisation, not quotations); Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026 (IR).

No deliverable prints annual visitors or permitted capacity for Table Mountain, Boulders, Robben Island, Cape Point or Kirstenbosch [flagship visitor counts and capacity: request from SANParks, the Cableway, Robben Island Museum and SANBI]. The only printed daily cap in hand is the City's permit system at the Witzands dunes near Atlantis, which is 80% pre-booked online (SME and Community Inclusion Plan, Sep 2026, p41).

Recommendation

Wesgro should stop marketing volume to the flagship sites and use them as the hook that sends visitors elsewhere. The Department of Economic Development wants further growth directed to under-visited parts of the province rather than constrained flagships (Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p24). The Peninsula route's own opportunities are to disperse visitors beyond the highest-volume attractions and to expand shoulder-season experiences (Infrastructure Report, Jul 2026, p30). The site operators hold the flow tools, from digital flow management to tiered pricing (Demand-Side Analysis, Jun 2026, p3; Stakeholder Insights Report, Mar 2026, p44).

Who acts	Action	Lead and partners
Wesgro	Market the under-used reserves, and the Southern Line to Boulders and Simon's Town, as alternatives to peak-hour flagship visits	Destination Marketing; CapeNature; PRASA
Wesgro	Request visitor counts and capacity for the five flagship sites and publish them as the baseline	Research; site operators
Wesgro	Report spend per visitor and length of stay for nature product alongside visitor numbers	Research
Partners	Introduce digital visitor-flow management at the Cableway, Boulders and Cape Point, and tiered pricing where mandates allow	Table Mountain Aerial Cableway; SANParks; CapeNature
Partners	Make reserve product climate-resilient by reassessing asset formats and siting	CapeNature
National	Agree a visitor management plan for Table Mountain National Park and Boulders with the City and the operators	SANParks

Benchmark precedent

Kenya treats conservation as national economic infrastructure, with tourism-funded conservation financing and community conservancies that sustain demand and environmental integrity (Global Benchmarking Report, Mar 2026, p33). New Zealand uses land-use controls and premium curation on the principle that capacity discipline protects long-term pricing power (p55).

Link forward

Initiative I11, flagship site demand management (section 4.3). **Indicator** T2-16 peak queue at the Cableway at outcome level, with flagship visitor counts added once the baseline is in hand (section 5.2).